Sales and marketing. Sales and marketing decreased $2.7 million, or 13.2%, in fiscal 2018 compared with fiscal 2017. The change is due primarily to a decrease of $2.2 million in incentive commissions related to revision of our commission plan from total contract value to annual contract value coupled with lower sales in fiscal 2018.

General and administrative. General and administrative increased $4.2 million, or 20.9%, in fiscal 2018 compared to fiscal 2017. The change is due primarily to increases of $2.5 million in stock compensation expense related to executive stock grants and the impact of removing forfeiture rates as a result of adopting ASU No. 2016-09, coupled with forfeitures in the prior year due to the departure of former executives. In addition, there was an increase of $1.6 million in payroll related expenses as a result of additional headcount including new hires throughout our operating locations.

Depreciation of fixed assets. Depreciation of fixed assets increased $0.2 million or 9.2% in fiscal 2018 as compared to fiscal 2017.

Amortization of intangibles. Amortization of intangibles increased $0.5 million, or 35.0%, in fiscal 2018 as compared to fiscal 2017 due to our latest version of rGuest Pay being placed into service on March 31, 2017.

Restructuring, severance and other charges. Restructuring, severance, and other charges increased $0.2 million during fiscal 2018 compared to fiscal 2017 related to our ongoing efforts to create more efficient teams across the business, which included certain executive changes during the year.

Our restructuring actions are discussed further in Note 4, *Restructuring Charges*.

Legal settlements. During fiscal 2018 and 2017, we recorded $0.2 million and $0.1 million, respectively, in legal settlements for employment and other business-related matters.

Other (Income) Expenses

(Dollars in thousands)	Year ended March 31, 2018	2017	(Unfavorable) favorable $	%
Other (income) expenses				
Interest (income)	$ (98)	$ (162)	$ (64)	(39.5)%
Interest expense	10	15	5	33.3 %
Other (income) expense, net	(391)	224	615	nm
Total other (income) expense, net	$ (479)	$ 77	$ 556	nm

nm - not meaningful

Interest income. Interest income decreased $64,000 during fiscal 2018 as compared to fiscal 2017.

Interest expense. Interest expense consists of costs associated with capital leases and loans on corporate-owned life insurance policies.

Other (income) expense, net. Other (income) expense, net consists mainly of the impact of foreign currency due to movement of European and Asian currencies against the US dollar.

Income Taxes

(Dollars in thousands)	Year ended March 31, 2018	2017	(Unfavorable) favorable $	%
Income tax (benefit) expense	$ (3,251)	$ 236	$ 3,487	nm
Effective tax rate	(28.0)%	(2.1)%		

nm - not meaningful

For fiscal 2018, the effective tax rate was different than the statutory rate due primarily to the impact of the Tax Act reform. The Company recorded a benefit of approximately $3.3 million resulting from the effect of a reduction in the deferred rate and the ability to offset indefinite lived deferred tax liabilities with certain deferred tax assets, recognition of net operating losses as deferred tax assets, which were offset by increases in the valuation allowance, certain foreign and state tax effects including a benefit of $0.4 million related to a settlement with the California Franchise Tax Board and other U.S. permanent book to tax differences. At March 31, 2018, we had $198.7 million of a federal net operating loss carryforward that expires, if unused, in fiscal years 2031 to 2038.